

DILNI ABEYRATHNE

Curriculum Vitae

Department of Geography | University of Kentucky
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Lexington, Kentucky 40506
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EDUCATION

MA	University of Kentucky College of Arts & Sciences Geography Graduate Certificate in Digital Mapping GPA: 4.0	May 2026
BA	University of Kentucky College of Arts & Sciences Lewis Honors College Environmental & Sustainability Studies Graduated: <i>Summa Cum Laude</i> GPA: 4.0	May 2023
BA	University of Kentucky College of Arts & Sciences Lewis Honors College Geography (with minor in Mapping & GIS) Graduated: <i>Summa Cum Laude</i> GPA: 4.0	May 2023
BA	University of Kentucky College of Arts & Sciences Lewis Honors College. International Studies Graduated: <i>Summa Cum Laude</i> GPA: 4.0	May 2023

HONORS AND AWARDS

Ellen Churchill Semple Award for Outstanding Undergraduate Research Paper University of Kentucky Department of Geography	2023
Gyula Pauer Cartography Award University of Kentucky Department of Geography	2023
Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF) University of Kentucky College of Arts & Sciences	2022
Raitz Scholarship University of Kentucky Department of Geography	2022
Gamma Theta Upsilon Honor Society University of Kentucky	2022 – present
Joseph R. Schwendeman Award University of Kentucky Department of Geography	2021 & 2022 & 2023
Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society University of Kentucky	2021 – 2022

Alpha Lambda Delta Honor Society
University of Kentucky

2020 – present

Dean's List
University of Kentucky | College of Arts & Sciences

2019 – 2023

Otis A. Singletary Scholarship
University of Kentucky | Lewis Honors College

2019 – 2023

RESEARCH & OTHER EXPERIENCES

Mapshop
University of Kentucky
Role: Cartographer & Research Assistant
Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Matthew W. Wilson
Website: <https://mapshop.as.uky.edu>

July 2021 – July 2023

Undergraduate Research Thesis - Geography
University of Kentucky
Role: Student Researcher
Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Ted Schatzki
Title: “Natural Realities: An Exploration of Perceptions on the Nature and Characterization of Restoration Ecologies Related to Mountaintop Removal (MTR) Mining in Eastern Kentucky”

January – May 2023

Undergraduate Research Thesis – International Studies
University of Kentucky
Role: Student Researcher
Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Diana E. King
Title: “Towards a Green Solace: Collective Identity, Sustainability, and Wishes for a New World”

January – May 2023

Documenting Racialized Violence in Kentucky (DRVK) Internship
University of Kentucky
Role: Intern, Cartographer, ARC/GIS Undergraduate Director of Mapping
Advisors/supervisors: Dr. Lynn Phillips, Dr. Nikki Brown, Dr. Melanie Goan
Website: <https://drvk.createuky.net>

September 2021 to May 2023

Cartography Commission
Scripps College
Role: Cartographer
Commissioner: Dr. Wendy Cheng

January 2023

Cartography Commission
University of Kentucky
Role: Cartographer
Commissioner: Dr. Lydia Pelot-Hobbs

October 2022

Summer Research Undergraduate Fellowship (SURF)
University of Kentucky
Role: Student Researcher
Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Nari Senanayake
Title: “Prismed Natures? Ties between the Reclamation of Mountaintop Removal Mining Sites and the Construction of Nature in Appalachia and Beyond”

May 2022 – August 2022

Paul Edwin Potter Internship

May 2022 – July 2022
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University of Kentucky, Kentucky Geological Survey

Role: Full-time Intern, Student Researcher, Cartographer

Advisor/supervisor: Dr. William Haneberg

Title: “From Perished Peaks to Sliding Slopes: Mapping Landslides and Environmental Justice on Select Mountaintop Removal Sites in Eastern Kentucky”

Undergraduate Research Thesis – Environmental & Sustainability Studies

January – May 2022

University of Kentucky

Role: Student Researcher

Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Betsy Beymer-Farris

Title: “Sliver Amongst the Forest: A Guide to Silvopasture in Kentucky”

Cartography Commission

June – July 2021

University of Kentucky

Role: Cartographer

Commissioner: Dr. Nari Senanayake

GRADUATE ASSISTANTSHIPS

Digital Mapping (GEO 109-004/011)

January 2025 – May 2025

University of Kentucky | Department of Geography

Role: Teaching Assistant (recitation leader, 2 sections)

Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Matthew Zook

U.S. Cities (GEO 220-001) & Cities of the World (GEO 222-001)

August 2024 – December 2024

University of Kentucky | Department of Geography

Role: Teaching Assistant (grader)

Advisor/supervisor: Dr. Andrew Wood & Dr. Lynn R. Phillips

MAP PUBLICATIONS

Cheng, W. (2023). *Island X: Taiwanese Student Migrants, Campus Spies, and Cold War Activism* (1st ed.). University of Washington Press.

Senanayake, N. (2021). Theorising liminal states of health: A spatio-temporal analysis of undiagnosis and anticipatory diagnosis in the shadow of toxic pollution. *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers*, 00, 1–15.

<https://doi.org/10.1111/tran.12504>

PRESENTATIONS

Paul Edwin Potter Intern Showcase (poster)

2022

University of Kentucky | Kentucky Geological Survey

Title: *From Perished Peaks to Sliding Slopes: Mapping Landslides and Environmental Justice on Select Mountaintop Removal Sites in Eastern Kentucky*

AFFILIATED ORGANIZATIONS, LEADERSHIP, & SERVICE

Kentucky Student Environmental Coalition, Lexington, KY

August 2022 – December 2024

Position: Community member, Greenthumb connection

Sri Lankan Student Association (SLSA) , University of Kentucky <u>Position:</u> Community member, EMS (Event Management System)/Events Officer, Undergraduate Representation	August 2021 – present
Greenthumb , University of Kentucky <u>Position:</u> Lead coordinator, Secretary, Co-Outreach Coordinator	August 2020 – May 2023
Sustainability Future Leaders , University of Kentucky <u>Position:</u> EMS Officer	October 2021 – May 2023
Philharmonia Orchestra , University of Kentucky <u>Position:</u> 2 nd violinist	August 2019 – April 2021
Sierra Club Climate Justice League , Sierra Club <u>Position:</u> Student Fellow	February – May 2020
Girls Group , Urban Impact <u>Position:</u> Volunteer	September – December 2019

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Interests: environmental science, sustainability, human-nature relations, environmental thought and understanding, environmental justice, critical/feminist/post-humanist geographies, political ecology, connections between epistemology/ideology and environmental management

LANGUAGES

Sinhala: native language, native fluency in all areas
English: second language, native fluency in all areas
Spanish & Korean: intermediate & novice in all areas, respectively

SKILLS

Software: QGIS, ESRI ArcGIS Pro, Adobe Suite (Acrobat, Illustrator, and Photoshop), ERDAS Imagine, GitHub, Blender